



32 The Quest For Quantumland



36 Big Blue Is Coming!



42 Red One

Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

Power Play

Extended gaming with standard equipment can't be good—not for your health, not for your ego. Here's how you can...er...save your health

Robert Sovereign Smith

Gaming is serious business—and no, we don't mean only for game developers and hardware vendors: we mean for the gamers as well. As with any sport (yes, gaming is now a sport!), talent doesn't always get you everywhere.

Serious gaming has some very basic requirements: talent, a good rig, precision instruments of control, and a certain *je ne sais quoi*—shall we leave it at oomph, or “coolth”? Let's face facts: most of the top gamers around the world aren't really Mr Universe material. What makes them icons are their skills at their games and the aura of technological wizardry that surrounds them. They all have the latest rigs, with bleeding edge technology at their fingertips, and quite vexingly, some of them don't pay a dime for it—it's all sponsored!

We aren't going to talk about the people who rule the roost—we'll save that for another time. What we *are* going to talk about is how you can get that something extra... that something else... that no one else has.

If you're a serious gamer, you probably have gamer friends. We're guessing here, but we're supposing all of you have pretty much similar gaming rigs. If you're not into PC gaming, you probably own an Xbox 360 already, and are eagerly awaiting the PS3—but then again, so are your friends...and a million others around the globe.

Wheat Or Chaff

It's your decision; choose wisely! Though it sounds like a line from a B grade action flick, you can do this the easy way or the hard way, and trust us, use the force, resist the dark side (umm... we meant the easy way).

Apart from owning consoles and SLI-ed or CrossFire-d graphics rigs, there are a few other things you might be interested in.

Take, for example, your mouse... it's boring, to say the least. Everyone has a mouse that, well, looks like



a mouse. If you're an FPS fanatic, you need something that says “I shoot people and demons in a virtual world...and I'm good at it!”

Let's start with a simple concept: You like shoot-em-ups; you're always using some gun in a game, but you're controlling it with a mouse that has a click button instead of a trigger. So why not use a gun-shaped control object instead? That's what the people at MonsterGecko (www.monstergecko.com)

have created for you: the PistolMouse FPS. This is a 900+ dpi mouse that's shaped like a pistol. It's ergonomically designed to keep your hand in a comfortable position, and has all three mouse buttons conveniently placed. But even if it didn't, we'd still want one, right? Here's the clincher though: this cool gadget costs a mere \$20 (Rs 950), so get online and e-mail that uncle/aunt/cousin/distant relative/complete stranger who's coming down from the US, and order one. Seriously, go right now—this magazine isn't going anywhere!

Back? OK! Another cool product is the Wolf Claw Type II keyboard. With a nice ergonomic controller on the left, to help you move better when playing FPS titles, this keyboard is a good buy at just \$50 (Rs 2,400).

Razer is another name that's well known in gaming circles, and their Copperhead mouse is a 2000 dpi precision instrument of destruction (if that's the type of games you play). At \$80 (Rs 3,800), it may seem expensive, but once you've used it, you'll realise why it's priced that way.

These products, however, are the usual suspects, and many a gamer will be sporting them. What will set you apart? There are a myriad products out there that cater to gaming. Some are affordable, some ridiculously not so. We've sifted through all the madness out there to come up with cool products that we think every gamer should want, if not already owned! Get out that tissue paper and be prepared to wipe away some drool/tears, after you turn the page...

